# British Expansion in South India: Conquest of Mysore and the Marathas (1767–1818)

## 1. Why the Company fought Mysore and the Marathas

- Regional expansion sought **revenue, ports and strategic territory**; Maratha **chauth/sardeshmukhi** claims generated rivalries. These conflicts enabled Company alliances and intervention.
- **Mysore:** Hyder/Tipu controlled Malabar pepper/cardamom commerce and threatened Madras; French links and improved military capacity alarmed Company. **Tipu's restrictions, 1785 and 1788**, curtailed exports/dealings with English traders.
- **Marathas:** control near Bombay and Gujarat challenged Company trade and territorial ambition. Cotton exports to China expanded in the **late eighteenth century**—the chapter's 1874 date is out of period.
- Company sought cheaper commerce, territorial revenues, military security and exclusion of French influence. Later European/Napoleonic wars intensified these concerns; they do not explain every earlier war.
- British claims to “restore legitimate dynasties” helped justify intervention, especially restoring **Wadiyars** after Tipu; restoration coexisted with imposed dependence.
- **Mysore wars: 1767–69, 1780–84, 1790–92, 1799**. **Maratha wars: 1775–82, 1803–05, 1817–18**. First Mysore war favoured Hyder; second ended by mutual restitution, not decisive British victory.

Warren Hastings · 1772–85
Mysore II · Maratha I

Cornwallis · 1786–93
Mysore III

Richard Wellesley · 1798–1805
Mysore IV · Maratha II

Lord Hastings · 1813–23
Pindaris · Maratha III

Link campaigns to the correct governor; Warren and Lord Hastings are different men.

## 2. First Anglo-Mysore War, 1767–69

- **Hyder Ali**, effective ruler from **1761**, faced shifting rivalry with Marathas, Hyderabad Nizam and Carnatic Nawab; English primarily acted through Madras.
- **Northern Circars:** strategic coastal link between Bengal and Madras; Company expansion and its **1766 agreement with Nizam** tied territorial rights to military support against Hyder.
- Nizam, Marathas and Company initially combined against Mysore. Hyder **bought off the Marathas and temporarily won over Nizam**, breaking the coalition; alliances changed again during the conflict.
- Hyder advanced to the vicinity of Madras and compelled peace. **Treaty of Madras, April 1769:** mutual restoration and promise of assistance if a third power attacked.

- **Result:** Hyder had the stronger negotiating position; no British conquest of Mysore.

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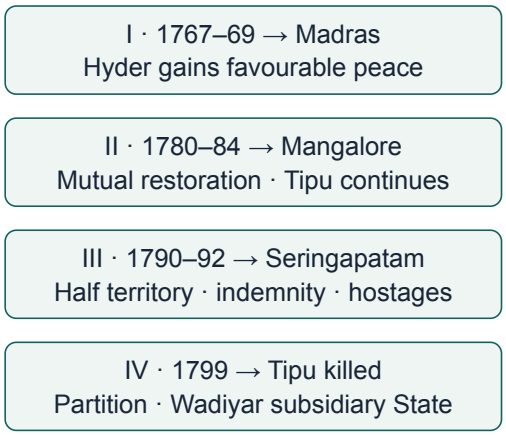
## 3. Second Anglo-Mysore War, 1780–84

- Company failed to aid Hyder against Marathas after the **1769 treaty**. **Capture of French Mahe, 1779**, threatened Mysore's military-supply connection; British movement towards Guntur also heightened tensions.
- **American War of Independence, 1775–83**, and Anglo-French conflict provided the wider setting. Hyder initially sought a coalition with Marathas/Nizam; British diplomacy subsequently isolated him.
- **Pollilur, 1780:** Mysorean victory over **Colonel Baillie's** force. **Porto Novo, July 1781: Eyre Coote defeated Hyder**. Do not confuse Baillie with French admiral Suffren.
- **Admiral Suffren** brought French naval support **1782**. **Hyder died, December 1782**; **Tipu Sultan** continued the war.
- End of European hostilities and exhaustion on both sides encouraged peace. **Treaty of Mangalore, March 1784:** mutual return of territories/prisoners; no decisive territorial British victory.
- Often described as an important British–Indian treaty on equal terms; avoid treating “last equal treaty” as an absolute claim about every later agreement.

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## 4. Third Anglo-Mysore War, 1790–92

- **Cornwallis** allied with **Nizam and Marathas**. Tipu sought external support through embassies to **Ottoman Constantinople and France**.
- **Immediate trigger:** Tipu's assault on **Travancore's Nedumkotta defences, late 1789**, renewed in 1790. Travancore had bought **Cranganore/Kodungallur and Ayacottah** from Dutch; Tipu disputed their transfer within the Cochin sphere.
- Cornwallis led the campaign towards **Seringapatam/Srirangapatna**; Tipu accepted peace.
- **Treaty of Seringapatam, March 1792:** lost **half his dominions** to Company and allies; Company gained **Malabar, Baramahal and Dindigul**. Nizam and Marathas also received territory.
- **Indemnity ₹3.3 crore (330 lakh sicca rupees)**; **two sons given as hostages** pending payment. The chapter rounds this to ₹3 crore; the treaty specifies three crore thirty lakh. Treaty collection Hostages belong to **Third War**, Tipu's death to **Fourth War**.
- Loss of Malabar reduced maritime access/resources. **John Shore, 1793–98**, then favoured non-intervention; distinct from **John Lawrence's later Afghan policy**.




Four Mysore wars: dates, settlements and outcomes.

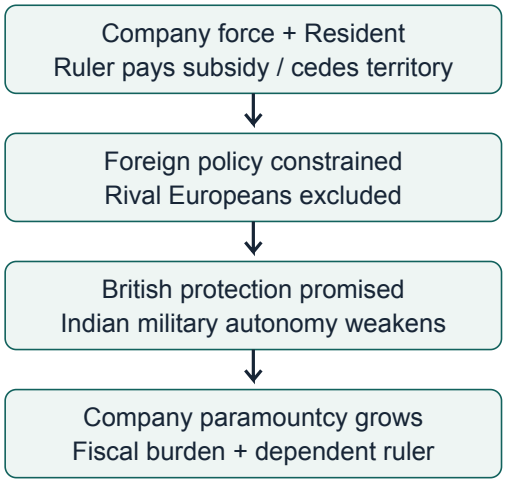
## 5. Fourth Anglo-Mysore War, 1799

- **Governor-General Richard Wellesley, 1798–1805:** feared French influence; Tipu's diplomatic contacts and refusal of demanded arrangements supplied the immediate setting.
- **Napoleon's Egyptian expedition, 1798**, raised British concern over India. His later **1801 Russian scheme** cannot be the chronological trigger of the 1799 war.
- Tipu's French/Jacobin contacts included the **Tree of Liberty/Citizen Tipu** association. **Monsieur Raymond's French-trained corps belonged to Hyderabad Nizam**, not Tipu's army. Telangana district history
- Nizam entered Company's **subsidiary alliance, 1798**, and his French corps was disbanded. British armies under **General George Harris**, including **Arthur Wellesley**, advanced on Mysore.
- **Seringapatam stormed, 4 May 1799**; Tipu killed defending the capital. No timely French rescue.
- Territory partitioned principally among **Company, Nizam and a restored Mysore kingdom**; Marathas did not receive the straightforward equal share implied by the chapter.
- **Krishnaraja Wadiyar III**, a child of about five, installed; **Purnaiah** served as diwan. A **1799 subsidiary treaty** made restored Mysore dependent; Tipu's family detained/pensioned, initially at **Vellore**.
- Company gained strategic coastal access; restored dynasty supplied a legitimacy claim while British control deepened. Wadiyar rule later included a period of direct British administration; it was not uninterrupted autonomous rule to 1947.

## 6. Subsidiary alliance: mechanism and effects

- Earlier protective arrangements existed; **Wellesley systematically expanded** this instrument alongside outright war and assumption of subordinated territories.
- Indian ruler accepted a **Company force** and paid a **subsidy or ceded territory** for its upkeep; received promised protection against external/internal threats.
- **Foreign relations restricted**; no independent treaty/war without Company approval. **British Resident** stationed; employment of European rivals restricted; military independence weakened.
- Company formally promised non-interference internally, yet Resident and troops enabled growing practical control.

- **Company gains:** forces maintained at allies' cost, forward strategic bases, exclusion of French officers, control of interstate diplomacy and expansion of paramountcy.
- **State costs:** lost sovereignty, heavy fiscal burden, taxation/territorial loss and displacement of soldiers; protected rulers faced weaker accountability to subjects. Subsidy terms varied—**one-third of revenue was not universal**.
- **Key agreements:** Hyderabad **1798/1800**; Mysore **1799**; Awadh **1801**; Peshwa **Bassein, 1802**; Scindia further agreement **1804**; Nagpur **1816**; Holkar **1818**.
- **Tanjore 1799, Carnatic 1801, Surat 1800:** assumption of administration/control needs distinction from a simple standard alliance. Rajput States were generally brought into treaty relationships, not all annexed outright.
- **Richard Wellesley = Governor-General; Arthur Wellesley = younger brother, soldier, later Duke of Wellington and British prime minister**. Do not interchange them.



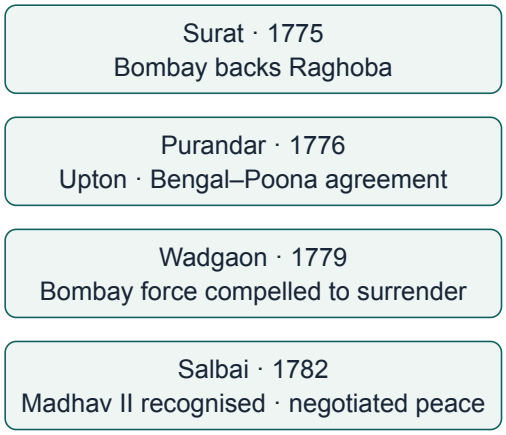

Protection tied to troops, payment and diplomatic dependence.

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## 7. Maratha confederacy and the first war, 1775–82

- **Peshwa—Poona; Scindia—Gwalior; Holkar—Indore; Bhonsle—Nagpur; Gaekwad—Baroda**. Nominal leadership did not eliminate independent armies, interests or Scindia–Holkar rivalry.
- After **Madhav Rao I died, 1772**, **Narayan Rao murdered, 1773**. **Barbhai council under Nana Phadnavis** installed Narayan's posthumous son **Sawai Madhav Rao II**; **Raghunath Rao/Raghoba** sought British support.
- Bombay Company's aim: **Salsette/Bassein**, commerce and influence at Poona. Bengal government under **Warren Hastings** initially opposed Bombay's arrangements.
- **Surat, March 1775:** Bombay backed Raghoba with troops; he promised **Salsette/Bassein and revenue interests in Surat/Broach**. **Keating's Adas campaign, May 1775**, followed.
- **Purandar, 1 March 1776: Colonel Upton**, Bengal government and Poona ministers; Surat agreement annulled; Raghoba pensioned; British retained specified territorial benefits. Use **1776**, not 1777. Maharashtra Gazetteer
- French envoy **St Lubin** at Poona and wider Anglo-French hostilities revived British intervention; disagreement among Company authorities continued.
- **Talegaon/Wadgaon, January 1779:** Maratha forces associated with **Mahadji Scindia and other commanders** trapped Bombay army through terrain, supply denial and mobile attacks.

- **Wadgaon convention, 1779:** British to return acquisitions made since 1773; Hastings rejected it. **Goddard captured Ahmedabad/Bassein; Popham captured Gwalior, 1780**, not 1781; **Camac's campaign/Sipri, 1781**, pressured Scindia.
- **Salbai, 1782**, mediated by **Mahadji Scindia: Madhav Rao II recognised; Raghoba pensioned; British retained Salsette/Elephanta and returned most recent conquests**, including Bassein; Scindia recovered territories west of Yamuna.
- **Result:** negotiated settlement, not decisive British conquest; roughly twenty years' peace between main parties. Company could concentrate on Mysore.

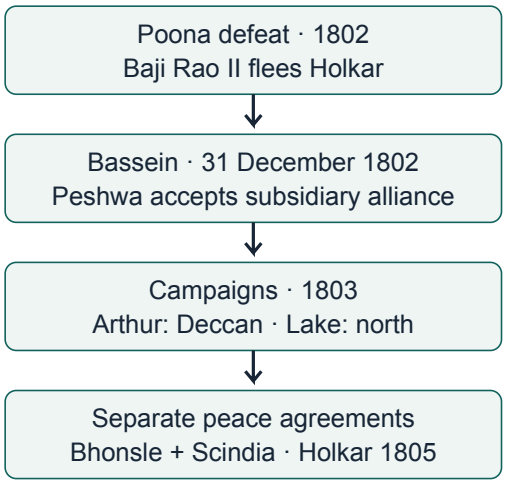



First Maratha war: four agreements, with differing Company policies.

## 8. Bassein and Second Anglo-Maratha War, 1803–05

- **Madhav Rao II died, 1795; Baji Rao II became Peshwa, 1796; Nana Phadnavis died, 1800**. Renewed factional rivalry undermined cooperation.
- **Vithoji Holkar executed, 1801**; **Yashwant Rao Holkar defeated Peshwa/Scindia at Poona, October 1802**. Peshwa fled to Bassein and sought Company help.
- **Treaty of Bassein, 31 December 1802: Baji Rao II** accepted subsidiary force/subsidy, restricted foreign relations and exclusion of hostile European officers. Nominal confederacy head became dependent.
- **Daulat Rao Scindia + Raghuji II Bhonsle** resisted; **Holkar did not initially join**, Gaekwad remained apart. Lack of combined action helped Company fight separately.
- **Deccan—Arthur Wellesley: Assaye, September 1803; Argaon/Argaum, November 1803; Gawilgarh, December**.
- **North—General Gerard Lake: Aligarh, Delhi, Agra; Laswari, November 1803**, against Scindia's forces. Delhi/Shah Alam II came under Company protection; not every northern battle involved a combined Scindia–Bhonsle army.
- Other operations covered **Gujarat, Bundelkhand and Odisha**.
- **Deogaon, December 1803—Bhonsle:** ceded **Cuttack/Balasore and territory west of Wardha**; accepted Resident **Mountstuart Elphinstone**. Distinguish these terms from the fuller Nagpur subsidiary arrangement **1816**.
- **Surji-Arjangaon, December 1803—Scindia:** surrendered major northern/central holdings, including **Ganga–Yamuna doab**; Company diplomatic control increased. **Burhanpur agreement, February 1804**, added subsidiary arrangements; **John Malcolm** important in negotiations.

- **Holkar war, 1804–05:** defeated **Monson's retreating force near Kota**; unsuccessful attempt on Delhi, defended under **Ochterlony**; later British successes at **Deeg and Farrukhabad**.
- Costly campaigns and European pressure led to **Wellesley's recall, 1805**; Cornwallis briefly returned, then **George Barlow** pursued retrenchment.
- **Rajpurghat, 24 December 1805:** peace with Holkar; relinquished northern claims, regained much territory; Company withdrew some commitments. Confederacy weakened; Company supremacy expanded, but Holkar was not finally reduced by this war alone.




Bassein enabled intervention and exposed the confederacy’s divisions.

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## 9. Pindaris and Third Anglo-Maratha War, 1817–18

- **Lord Hastings, 1813–23**—different from **Warren Hastings**. Expansion also included **Anglo-Nepal War, 1814–16**, and suppression of Pindaris.
- **Pindaris:** mobile irregular raiding bands, often linked to Maratha armies; heterogeneous recruits included displaced soldiers/peasants. Plunder financed operations; not a single ethnic/religious community or formal regular army.
- **Leaders: Chitu, Wasil Muhammad, Karim Khan**. Raids in Company territories, including **Mirzapur/Shahabad, 1812, and Northern Circars, 1816**, supplied justification for a large campaign.
- **1817–18:** Hastings led northern forces; **Thomas Hislop** commanded Deccan army. Bands dispersed/crushed; Karim surrendered, Wasil died in custody and Chitu was reportedly killed by a tiger after flight.
- **Nagpur, 27 May 1816:** succession dispute after Raghuji II's death; **Appa Sahib/Mudhoji II**, Resident **Jenkins** and subsidiary force. **Parsoji** nominal ruler amid regency conflict.
- **Gangadhar Shastri, Gaekwad envoy, murdered at Pandharpur, 1815**, not Nasik. **Trimbakji Dengle** implicated; Elphinstone's demands intensified Peshwa–Company conflict. Satara Gazetteer
- **Poona, 13 June 1817:** Peshwa accepted further restrictions, territorial cessions and renunciation of confederacy leadership.
- **Gwalior, 5 November 1817:** Scindia agreed to assist anti-Pindari campaign and accept restrictions; remained out of the principal anti-British war. This was not a Company conquest of Gwalior.
- **Peshwa—Khadki/Kirkee, 5 November 1817; Bhonsle—Sitabaldi, 26–27 November; Holkar—Mahidpur, 21 December:** British victories. Peshwa had attacked/burned Poona residency.

- **Mandsaur, 6 January 1818—Malhar Rao Holkar II:** subsidiary dependence, territorial cessions and British influence; **Tantia Jog** important in the settlement. Holkar the last major Maratha house subjected in this sequence. Jalgaon Gazetteer
- **Koregaon, 1 January 1818:** Company detachment resisted Peshwa's larger force; distinguish this engagement from final surrender. **Ashti, 20 February 1818:** Peshwa's commander **Bapu Gokhale killed**.
- **Baji Rao II surrendered to Malcolm, June 1818**; **Peshwaship abolished**, pensioned at **Bithoor**. Territory enlarged Bombay Presidency; **Satara under Pratap Singh**, Shivaji's descendant, created as a dependent kingdom.
- **Result:** Maratha confederacy dismantled; British paramountcy dominant across much of India. **Punjab and Sindh** among major remaining powers; “every part of the subcontinent already conquered in 1818” is too sweeping.

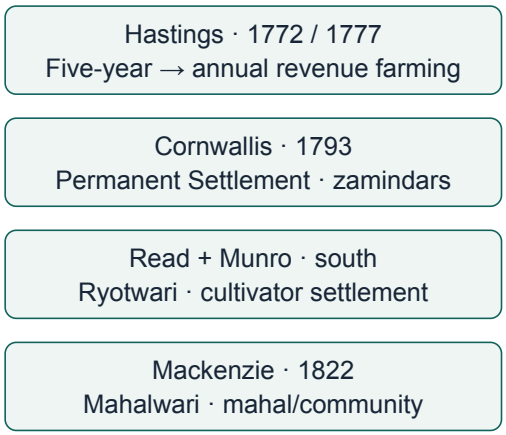



Third war consolidated paramountcy and ended the Peshwa’s office.

## 10. Administrative reforms alongside expansion

- **Warren Hastings:** Bengal governor **1772**; first **Governor-General of Bengal from 1774 under Regulating Act, 1773**—not Governor-General of all India. Ended dual government **1772**; removed deputy diwans, expanded Company revenue control and shifted treasury **Murshidabad → Calcutta**.
- **Revenue:** five-year/quinquennial farming **1772**, highest-bidder collection → excessive extraction/speculation; **annual settlements from 1777**. Neither was Permanent Settlement.
- **Justice:** district **diwani adalats—civil; faujdari adalats—criminal**; appeals **Sadr Diwani/Sadr Nizamat**. Hindu/Muslim personal law and Islamic criminal law applied in relevant spheres.
- **Supreme Court, Calcutta, 1774:** separate English-law institution; overlapping jurisdictions caused conflicts. **Halhed's Code of Gentoo Laws, 1776**, translated via Persian from a Sanskrit compilation.
- **Cornwallis, 1786–93:** decennial revenue settlement **1790**, made **Permanent, 1793**; zamindars recognised as proprietors subject to fixed State demand. Claimed rental division roughly **89% State/11% zamindar**, not a universal tax on every peasant's produce.
- **Cornwallis Code, 1793:** separated revenue collection from judicial functions; district judges, reorganisation of courts/police and criminal-law reforms. Intention in homicide mattered; harsher bodily penalties restricted; evidentiary rules changed.
- Anti-corruption: higher salaries, restraints on private trade and gifts/property declaration. **Racial exclusion** reserved higher posts for Europeans; elaborate courts and language/cost barriers limited equal access.
- **Lord Hastings' period: Thomas Munro—Madras governor, 1820**, extended **Ryotwari**, direct settlement with cultivators; earlier work with **Alexander Read** preceded him.

- **Holt Mackenzie's Regulation VII, 1822—Mahalwari**, settlement through mahal/village proprietors/community; later developed further. Collector–magistrate combination qualified Cornwallis's separation. IGNOU: agrarian systems




Revenue systems differed in intermediary, duration and region.

## 11. Why Mysore and Marathas lost: balanced Mains explanation

- **Diplomacy and fragmentation:** rival States/chiefs failed to sustain coordination; Company used succession disputes, separate treaties and selective alliances.
- **Fiscal resources:** Bengal revenue, commercial credit, maritime links and British support sustained campaigns. Indian mobilisation was uneven; Maratha tribute networks vulnerable, Mysore's coastal losses damaging.
- **Military organisation:** reliable supply, command, drill, artillery and intelligence mattered. Company armies relied heavily on Indian sepoys and allies.
- **Qualification:** Mysore modernised arms/rockets and administration; Scindia had European-trained units; Marathas defeated Company at Wadgaon. Defeat was not inevitable or evidence of inherently “static Indians” versus “dynamic Europeans”.
- **Exam method:** distinguish capacity from outcome; explain how Company converted particular advantages into victory through institutions, resources and diplomacy.

## 12. PYQ recall and answer frameworks

- **Prelims 2001:** modern overseas embassies—**Tipu Sultan, (d)**; retained once in common JSON and linked to this chapter.
- **Prelims 2003, assertion–reason:** Marathas became a leading native power—**A true**; first clear concept of a united Indian nation—**R false → (c)**. Supplied key **(a)** is incorrect; eighteenth-century confederacy was not modern national unity.
- **Prelims 2003, annexations: Satara 1848 → Sambalpur 1849 → Jhansi 1853–54 → 3–2–1, (c)**. Distinguish decision/implementation dates for Jhansi; order unaffected.
- **Prelims 2018:** “secure a fixed income” is **not the defining aim of subsidiary alliance → (c)**; army at allies' cost, exclusion of French threat and paramountcy are central.

- **Mains 2010, Dalhousie's annexations:** test the claimed contrast with predecessors—Wellesley/Hastings also expanded aggressively; distinguish **war** (Punjab/Lower Burma), **lapse** (Satara/Nagpur/Jhansi) and **misgovernment claim** (Awadh). Evaluate legal justifications versus imperial objectives.
- **Mains 2013, founder of modern India:** assess railways, telegraph, postal/public-works and administrative changes alongside annexations and their colonial military/commercial purposes; “founder” needs qualification, not uncritical praise. Detailed Dalhousie study belongs to the later chapter.
- **Mains 2022, Company military success:** structure around finance, command, logistics, training, naval support, diplomacy and fragmented opposition; use **Wadgaon as counterexample**, **Mysore modernisation**, and **Indian composition of Company army**. Greater numbers/equipment alone did not ensure cohesion or victory.